Shivanshu Saini

TOP 10

CHALLENGES FACED IN SELENIUM

Common problems → Simple fixes
| For every Automation Tester

www.reallygreatsite.com

1. Dynamic XPaths

Challenge:
Elements with changing attributes (id, class, etc.)

Fix:
✅ Use **contains/text-based** XPath
✅ Prefer CSS selectors where possible
Example: //input[contains(@id, 'username')]

LEARN MORE

shivanshu.saini65@gmail.com

Thynk Unlimited

2. StaleElementReferenceException

Challenge:
Element is no longer attached to the DOM.
Fix:
🔄 Re-locate the element before action
🕒 **Use** ExpectedConditions.refreshed() if using WebDriverWait

```
driver.navigate().refresh();
element = driver.findElement(...);
```

3. Synchronization Issues

Challenge:
Script runs faster than web elements load.
Fix:
⏱️ **Prefer Explicit Waits** over Thread.sleep
Use WebDriverWait with expected conditions.

```
new WebDriverWait(driver, 10)
.until(ExpectedConditions.visibility
Of(element));
```

4. Handling Popups/Alerts

Challenge:
Unexpected JavaScript alerts block execution.
Fix:
🛑 Use driver.switchTo().alert()

```
Alert alert = driver.switchTo().alert();
alert.accept();
```

5. Dropdown Handling

Challenge:
Select elements using visible text or index.
Fix:
Use the Select class in Selenium

```
Select select = new Select(element);
select.selectByVisibleText("Option");
```

LEARN AND GROW

6. iFrame Switching

Challenge:
Elements inside <iframe> not directly accessible.
Fix:
Switch to iframe before interacting:

```
driver.switchTo().frame("frameName");
// perform actions
driver.switchTo().defaultContent();
```

shivanshu.saini65@gmail.com

7. Test Flakiness

Challenge:
Tests fail inconsistently across runs.
Fix:
✅ Stable locators
✅ Explicit waits
✅ Data cleanup before tests
✅ Isolate test data

shivanshu.saini65@gmail.com

8. Browser Compatibility Issues

Challenge:
Script behaves differently in different browsers.

Fix:

✔ Use cross-browser testing tools (BrowserStack/Sauce Labs)

✔ Avoid browser-dependent locators/styles

✔ Use WebDriverManager for handling drivers.

shivanshu.saini65@gmail.com

9. File Uploads

Challenge:
Can't interact with native file dialogs.
Fix:
Use **sendKeys()** with file path directly on input element:

```
driver.findElement(By.id("upload")).sendKeys("C:\\path\\file.png");
```

shivanshu.saini65@gmail.com

10. Parallel Execution Issues

Challenge:
Tests interfering with each other when running in parallel.
Fix:
🛠️ Use ThreadLocal WebDriver
✅ Configure TestNG parallel="tests"
✅ Keep test data isolated

shivanshu.saini65@gmail.com

Conclusion

“You're not a tester if you haven’t battled these bugs. But you’re a pro if you’ve solved them. 💪”

CTA (Call to Action):

💬 **Which of these challenges haunted you the most? Let’s talk in the comments!**

shivanshu.saini65@gmail.com